

COMPLETE BLENDER CINEMATOGRAPHY & GREASE PENCIL MASTERY COURSE

Project-Based Learning Path for Fast Learners

Created for: BGEC

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Course Structure

- **Duration:** 12-16 weeks (flexible)
- **Daily Investment:** 30-90 minutes
- **Learning Style:** Video tutorials + Hands-on projects
- **End Goal:** Create professional cinematic scenes with 2D/3D integration

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1 Phase 1: Foundations (Weeks 1-3)

1.1 Week 1: Blender Interface & Basic Modeling

1.1.1 Learning Objectives

- Master Blender 4.x interface navigation
- Understand viewport controls and shortcuts
- Learn essential modeling tools
- Complete your first 3D object

1.1.2 Video Resources

1. [Polygon Runway - Full Blender 4 Course for Complete Beginners](#) (Free, 2024)
 - Chapters 1-3: Interface, transforms, basic modeling
 - Duration: ~2 hours total
2. [Learn Blender 4.2 Fast: Complete Beginner's Crash Course](#) (2024)
 - Interface overview and quick start
 - Duration: ~45 minutes

1.1.3 MINI-PROJECTS (Week 1)

Project 1.1: Simple Still Life Scene (Day 3-4)

Goal: Create a basic table scene with 3-5 objects
Skills: Box modeling, basic transforms, object placement
Time: 60-90 minutes
Deliverable: Rendered image of your still life

Project 1.2: Low-Poly Room Corner (Day 5-7)

Goal: Model a corner of a room with furniture
Skills: Extrusion, loop cuts, modifiers (Array, Mirror)
Time: 90-120 minutes
Deliverable: Simple room corner with 3+ furniture pieces

1.2 Week 2: Materials, Shading & Lighting Basics

1.2.1 Learning Objectives

- Understand PBR materials and the Shader Editor
- Master basic lighting setups

- Learn render engines (Eevee vs Cycles)
- Create mood through lighting

1.2.2 Video Resources

1. [Polygon Runway Course](#) - Materials and Colors chapter
2. [Make Your Renders POP! - Blender Lighting & Composition Guide](#) (2024)
 - Duration: ~30 minutes
3. [The Art of Lighting in Blender - CG Fast Track](#)

1.2.3 PROJECTS (Week 2)

Project 2.1: Material Study Collection (Day 1-3)

Goal: Create 5 spheres with different materials

Materials to create: Metal, Glass, Wood, Plastic, Fabric

Skills: Shader nodes, PBR workflow, texturing

Time: 90 minutes

Deliverable: Rendered lineup of 5 spheres

Project 2.2: Three-Mood Scene (Day 4-7)

Goal: Take your Week 1 room and light it three different ways

Moods: Morning (warm), Night (cool), Dramatic (high contrast)

Skills: 3-point lighting, HDRI lighting, color temperature

Time: 120-150 minutes

Deliverable: 3 rendered images showing different moods

1.3 Week 3: Camera Fundamentals & Composition

1.3.1 Learning Objectives

- Master camera settings and focal lengths
- Apply composition principles (rule of thirds, leading lines)
- Understand depth of field
- Create dynamic camera angles

1.3.2 Video Resources

1. [Blender Studio - Camera Control & Basic Cinematography](#)
2. [Blender Camera Work: Composition Tips](#) (2024 article)
3. [CG Cookie - Directing The Camera in Blender](#)

1.3.3 MAJOR PROJECT (Week 3)

Project 3: "The Detective's Office" (Full Week)

Goal: Create a cinematic noir-style office scene

Requirements:

- Model a desk, chair, lamp, window with blinds
- Apply appropriate materials
- Set up dramatic film noir lighting (high contrast, venetian blind shadows)
- Create 5 different camera angles of the same scene
- Apply composition rules to each shot

Skills Used: All Week 1-3 skills combined

Time: 4-5 hours total

Deliverable: 5 rendered shots from different angles, one "hero shot" in high quality

2 Phase 2: Cinematography Deep Dive (Weeks 4-7)

2.1 Week 4: Advanced Camera Techniques & Animation

2.1.1 Learning Objectives

- Animate cameras with keyframes
- Create camera movements (dolly, pan, tilt, tracking shots)
- Use camera constraints and rigs
- Master the Graph Editor for smooth motion

2.1.2 Video Resources

1. [Cinematic tutorial Blender 4.0 - 2h 30 min](#) (Comprehensive cinematography guide)
2. [Blender Studio - Camera Control tutorials](#) (multiple chapters)

2.1.3 PROJECTS (Week 4)

Project 4.1: Camera Movement Studies (Day 1-3)

Goal: Create 4 different camera movements in simple scenes

Movements: Dolly in, Pan across, Orbit around object, Tracking shot

Time: 60 minutes each

Deliverable: 4 short animations (5-10 seconds each)

Project 4.2: "Product Reveal" (Day 4-7)

Goal: Create a professional product reveal animation

Requirements:

- Model or download a product (watch, phone, bottle)
- Dramatic lighting setup
- Smooth camera reveal movement
- 10-15 second animation

Skills: Camera animation, lighting, timing, rendering animation

Time: 150-180 minutes

Deliverable: Rendered animation with smooth camera movement

2.2 Week 5: Color Grading & Atmosphere

2.2.1 Learning Objectives

- Master the Compositor

- Create atmospheric effects (fog, volumetrics, god rays)
- Apply color grading for mood
- Use render layers and passes

2.2.2 Video Resources

1. [Blender Lighting & Composition Guide](#) - Color grading section
2. [Lighting and Composition Techniques - Whizzy Studios](#) (2024)
3. Compositor tutorials from CG Cookie

2.2.3 PROJECTS (Week 5)

Project 5.1: Atmosphere Experiments (Day 1-3)

Goal: Create 3 scenes with different atmospheric effects
Effects: Heavy fog forest, Dusty warehouse with god rays, Underwater scene
Time: 60-90 minutes each
Deliverable: 3 atmospheric renders

Project 5.2: "Color Grading Challenge" (Day 4-7)

Goal: Take one scene and create 5 different color grades
Grades: Blockbuster teal/orange, Horror desaturated, Warm nostalgia, Cyberpunk neon, Natural documentary
Skills: Compositor nodes, color theory, mood creation
Time: 120 minutes
Deliverable: 5 versions of same scene with different grades

2.3 Week 6: Environment Creation & Scene Building

2.3.1 Learning Objectives

- Build large-scale environments
- Use modular asset workflows
- Apply efficient scene management
- Create believable spaces

2.3.2 Video Resources

1. [Create Large-scale 3D Environments in Blender](#) (2024)
2. [From Zero to Hero | How To Model 3D Environment](#) (2024)
3. [Master Urban Environments in Blender - CG Boost](#) (Paid but excellent)

2.3.3 MAJOR PROJECT (Week 6)

Project 6: "Abandoned Subway Station" (Full Week)

Goal: Create a full cinematic environment

Requirements:

- Model platform, tracks, pillars, debris
- Use modular assets for efficiency
- Add atmospheric fog and dramatic lighting
- Create at least 3 cinematic camera angles
- Apply color grading

Skills: All previous skills + environment design

Time: 5-7 hours total

Deliverable: 3 high-quality cinematic renders of your environment

2.4 Week 7: Animation Fundamentals for Cinematics

2.4.1 Learning Objectives

- Understand 12 principles of animation
- Master Timeline and Graph Editor
- Create basic object animation
- Combine camera and object movement

2.4.2 Video Resources

1. Official Blender tutorials on animation basics
2. Animation courses from CG Cookie or Blender Studio
3. 12 Principles of Animation resources

2.4.3 PROJECTS (Week 7)

Project 7.1: Animation Principles Studies (Day 1-4)

Goal: Create 5 short animations demonstrating principles

Principles to show: Squash & stretch, Anticipation, Staging, Follow-through, Timing

Time: 45 minutes each

Deliverable: 5 short animation clips

Project 7.2: "The Chase" (Day 5-7)

Goal: Create a 15-20 second action sequence

Requirements:

- Animate a simple character or object being chased
- Include camera following movement
- Add secondary animation (debris, dust, etc.)
- Apply sound effects (optional)

Time: 180-240 minutes

Deliverable: Fully animated and rendered chase sequence

3 Phase 3: Grease Pencil Mastery (Weeks 8-10)

3.1 Week 8: Grease Pencil Fundamentals

3.1.1 Learning Objectives

- Master Grease Pencil interface and tools
- Understand layers and materials
- Create basic 2D drawings
- Learn frame-by-frame animation basics

3.1.2 Video Resources

1. [New to Animation? Learn Grease Pencil!](#) (2024)
2. [Grease Pencil: Easy Animation for Beginners - Blender 4.4](#) (2024)
3. [Learn Grease Pencil in 10 MINUTES](#) (2024)
4. [Blender Studio - Grease Pencil Fundamentals](#) (Official course)

3.1.3 PROJECTS (Week 8)

Project 8.1: Character Design Sheet (Day 1-3)

Goal: Design and draw a simple character from multiple angles

Requirements: Front, side, back, 3/4 view

Time: 90-120 minutes

Deliverable: Character turnaround sheet

Project 8.2: "Walk Cycle" (Day 4-7)

Goal: Create a basic character walk cycle

Requirements:

- 8-12 frame loop
- Use onion skinning
- Clean line art with simple color

Time: 150-180 minutes

Deliverable: Looping walk cycle animation

3.2 Week 9: Advanced Grease Pencil & Effects

3.2.1 Learning Objectives

- Master Grease Pencil modifiers

- Create effects and motion graphics
- Understand advanced layer techniques
- Use materials creatively

3.2.2 Video Resources

1. [EVERYTHING You Need to Animate with Blender Grease Pencil](#) (Comprehensive guide)
2. [2D Animation Tutorial - Grease Pencil tips for Beginners & Advanced](#) (2024)
3. [Blender 5.0 Manual - Grease Pencil Animation](#) (Official docs)

3.2.3 PROJECTS (Week 9)

Project 9.1: "Motion Graphics Title Sequence" (Day 1-4)

Goal: Create a 10-second animated title card

Requirements:

- Animated text reveal
- Graphic elements and shapes
- Use modifiers for effects
- Color and style treatment

Time: 120-150 minutes

Deliverable: Animated title sequence

Project 9.2: "Expressive Animation" (Day 5-7)

Goal: Create a short emotional animation

Requirements:

- 5-10 seconds showing an emotion (surprise, joy, sadness)
- Character facial animation or body language
- Background elements
- Effects (speed lines, impact frames, etc.)

Time: 180-240 minutes

Deliverable: Short expressive animation clip

3.3 Week 10: 2D/3D Integration

3.3.1 Learning Objectives

- Combine Grease Pencil with 3D scenes

- Match 2D elements to 3D camera movement
- Create hybrid visual styles
- Master depth and composition in mixed media

3.3.2 Video Resources

1. [The Easiest Way to Animate in Blender - Grease Pencil Introduction](#) (2025)
2. Blender Studio - Grease Pencil resources and project files
3. Community tutorials on 2D/3D hybrid workflows

3.3.3 MAJOR PROJECT (Week 10)

Project 10: "Hybrid Scene - The Magical Library" (Full Week)

Goal: Create a scene mixing 3D environment with 2D animated elements

Requirements:

- 3D modeled library environment
- 2D Grease Pencil animated books flying around
- 2D magical effects (sparkles, wisps, runes)
- Animated camera movement through scene
- 15-20 second animation
- Full lighting and color grading

Skills: Everything learned so far

Time: 6-8 hours total

Deliverable: Fully rendered 2D/3D hybrid animation

4 Phase 4: Advanced VFX & Cinematic Production (Weeks 11-14)

4.1 Week 11: Particles & Simulations

4.1.1 Learning Objectives

- Master particle systems
- Create realistic simulations (smoke, fire, explosions)
- Use physics simulations effectively
- Integrate VFX into cinematic shots

4.1.2 Video Resources

1. [Particle Simulation In Blender | Particles FXs](#) (2024)
2. [Blender Particles VFX | Molecular + Tutorial](#) (2024)
3. [Particles VFX: Procedural Particle System v2.3 Geometry Nodes](#) (2024)
4. [Complete Tutorial for Blender Visual Effects - Class Central](#) (Free course)

4.1.3 PROJECTS (Week 11)

Project 11.1: VFX Elements Library (Day 1-4)

Goal: Create 5 reusable VFX elements

Effects: Smoke plume, Fire burst, Dust cloud, Rain, Magic sparkles

Time: 60 minutes each

Deliverable: 5 VFX elements with alpha for compositing

Project 11.2: "The Portal" (Day 5-7)

Goal: Create a magical portal opening scene

Requirements:

- Particle-based portal effect
- Energy wisps and sparks
- Camera movement revealing the portal
- 10-15 second animation
- Sound design (optional)

Time: 180-240 minutes

Deliverable: Fully composited portal opening sequence

4.2 Week 12: Advanced Compositing & Post-Production

4.2.1 Learning Objectives

- Master advanced Compositor workflows
- Use render layers and passes effectively
- Create professional color grades
- Add final polish effects (grain, chromatic aberration, vignette)

4.2.2 Video Resources

1. Advanced compositing tutorials from CG Cookie
2. Color grading masterclasses
3. Professional finishing techniques

4.2.3 PROJECTS (Week 12)

Project 12.1: "Shot Remaster" (Day 1-3)

Goal: Take 3 of your previous projects and remaster them

Requirements:

- Apply professional color grading
- Add finishing effects
- Improve lighting if needed
- Create "before and after" comparisons

Time: 90 minutes per project

Deliverable: 3 remastered shots with before/after

Project 12.2: "Film Look Study" (Day 4-7)

Goal: Recreate the look of 3 famous films

Films to study: Choose 3 (e.g., Blade Runner 2049, The Grand Budapest Hotel, Mad Max: Fury Road)

Requirements:

- Analyze the color palettes
- Recreate the look in a simple scene
- Document your process

Time: 120 minutes per study

Deliverable: 3 renders matching different film aesthetics

4.3 Week 13-14: FINAL CINEMATIC PROJECT

4.3.1 CAPSTONE PROJECT: "Your Cinematic Short"

Goal: Create a 30-60 second cinematic sequence showcasing all learned skills

Requirements 1. Pre-Production (Days 1-2)

- Write a simple story/concept
- Create storyboards (hand-drawn or Grease Pencil)
- Plan your shots and camera movements
- Gather references

2. Production (Days 3-10)

- Model/gather all necessary assets
- Set dress your environment(s)
- Apply materials and textures
- Set up lighting for each shot
- Create camera movements
- Add any Grease Pencil elements
- Animate objects if needed
- Add VFX elements

3. Post-Production (Days 11-14)

- Render all shots
- Composite and color grade
- Add finishing touches
- Edit together in Blender's Video Sequencer
- Add sound design/music (optional)
- Export final video

Suggested Themes (choose one)

- **"Last Light"** - A lone character in a post-apocalyptic environment watching the sunset
- **"The Heist"** - A stylized sequence of a character stealing a valuable item
- **"Awakening"** - A robot/android coming to life in a laboratory

- **"The Journey"** - A traveler discovering a magical/sci-fi location
- **Your own concept!**

Time Investment: 12-16 hours total

Deliverable:

- Final rendered cinematic short (30-60 seconds)
- Behind-the-scenes breakdown images
- Project files organized properly

5 Comprehensive Resource Library

5.1 Learning Platforms

5.1.1 Free Resources

1. Blender Studio (<https://studio.blender.org>)

- Official Blender courses
- Project files from Blender movies
- Production tutorials

2. YouTube Channels

- Polygon Runway - Beginner-friendly, project-based
- CG Cookie (free tutorials) - Technical deep dives
- Blender Official Channel - Latest features
- Grant Abbitt - Beginner to intermediate
- Default Cube - Quick tips and tricks
- Ryan King Art - Cinematography focus
- CrossMind Studio - Advanced techniques

3. Written Resources

- Blender Artists Forum (<https://blenderartists.org>)
- BlenderNation (<https://blendernation.com>) - News and tutorials
- Blender Manual (<https://docs.blender.org>) - Official documentation

5.1.2 Paid Resources (Worth Considering)

1. CG Boost (<https://cgboost.com>)

- Master Cinematic Storytelling in Blender
- High-quality production courses

2. CG Cookie (<https://cgcookie.com>)

- Subscription-based learning
- Structured learning paths
- Project files and community

3. Udemy (Watch for sales!)

- Blender 4 Visual Effects course
- Various specialized courses

4. CG Fast Track (<https://cgfasttrack.com>)

- Beginner-friendly approach
- Strong community support

5.2 Asset Libraries (Free)

5.2.1 3D Models

- Poly Haven (<https://polyhaven.com>) - Free HDRIs, textures, models
- Sketchfab (<https://sketchfab.com>) - Free section with many downloads
- BlenderKit (Built into Blender) - Free and paid assets
- Quixel Megascans (via Epic Games) - Free with Unreal Engine account

5.2.2 Textures

- Poly Haven (<https://polyhaven.com>)
- AmbientCG (<https://ambientcg.com>)
- Texture Haven (<https://texturehaven.com>)
- CC0 Textures (<https://cc0textures.com>)

5.2.3 HDRIs

- Poly Haven (<https://polyhaven.com>) - Best free HDRIs
- HDRI Haven (<https://hdrihaven.com>)

5.2.4 Sounds & Music

- Freesound (<https://freesound.org>)
- YouTube Audio Library
- Incompetech (<https://incompetech.com>) - Royalty-free music

5.3 Essential Add-ons

5.3.1 Free (Built-in)

1. **Node Wrangler** - Essential for materials
2. **Bool Tool** - Boolean operations made easy
3. **Extra Objects** - More primitives
4. **Archimesh** - Architectural elements

5.3.2 Paid (Optional but powerful)

1. **Hard Ops / Boxcutter** - Hard surface modeling
2. **Real Camera** - Professional camera controls
3. **Cinematography LUT** - Color grading presets

6 Learning Methodology

6.1 Daily Practice Structure

6.1.1 30-minute sessions

- 5 min: Review previous day's work
- 20 min: Follow tutorial or work on project
- 5 min: Save work and plan next session

6.1.2 60-minute sessions

- 5 min: Review and setup
- 40 min: Active learning/project work
- 10 min: Experimentation and documentation
- 5 min: Save and reflect

6.1.3 90+ minute sessions

- 10 min: Review and planning
- 60 min: Deep focus on project
- 15 min: Experimentation with new techniques
- 5 min: Documentation and saving

6.2 Learning Tips

6.2.1 1. Master Shortcuts Early

- **G** (Grab/Move), **R** (Rotate), **S** (Scale)
- **E** (Extrude), **I** (Inset), **Ctrl+R** (Loop Cut)
- **Tab** (Edit/Object mode), **Z** (Shading menu)
- **Shift+A** (Add menu), **X** (Delete)

6.2.2 2. Save Frequently

- **Ctrl+S** every few minutes
- Use incremental saves (Save As > + icon)
- Version your projects: `project_v01`, `project_v02`

6.2.3 3. Organize Your Files

```
ProjectName/  
  blend_files/  
  textures/  
  references/  
  renders/  
  final/
```

6.2.4 4. Build a Portfolio

- Create an ArtStation or Behance account
- Post your projects weekly
- Write about your process
- Engage with the community

6.2.5 5. Join Communities

- **r/blender** (Reddit) - Very active, helpful
- **Blender Artists Forum** - Technical discussions
- **Discord servers** - Real-time help
- **Local meetups** (if available)

6.2.6 6. Weekly Review

- Every Sunday, review your week's work
- Identify what you struggled with
- Plan focus areas for next week
- Celebrate your progress!

7 Progress Tracking

7.1 Milestone Checklist

7.1.1 Weeks 1-3: Foundation

- Created first 3D object
- Completed still life scene
- Rendered first lit scene
- Completed "Detective's Office" project
- Comfortable with interface navigation

7.1.2 Weeks 4-7: Cinematography

- Animated first camera movement
- Created product reveal animation
- Completed atmospheric renders
- Built first full environment
- Comfortable with lighting and composition

7.1.3 Weeks 8-10: Grease Pencil

- Drew first character design
- Animated walk cycle
- Created motion graphics
- Completed 2D/3D hybrid project
- Comfortable with Grease Pencil tools

7.1.4 Weeks 11-14: Advanced & Final

- Created particle simulations
- Completed VFX project
- Mastered color grading
- Finished capstone cinematic short
- Built a portfolio

8 Next Steps After Completion (Optional)

8.1 Continue Learning

1. **Specialize:** Choose cinematography, character animation, or VFX
2. **Advanced Courses:** Invest in specialized paid courses
3. **Study Real Films:** Analyze cinematography from movies
4. **Collaborate:** Find others for larger projects

8.2 Build Even More Skills

1. **30-Day Challenge:** Create a render every day
2. **Recreate Shots:** Copy shots from your favorite films
3. **Client Work:** Offer services on Fiverr or Upwork
4. **Personal Projects:** Create a short film or series

8.3 Community Engagement

1. **Weekly Art Challenge:** Participate in r/blender challenges
2. **Tutorial Creation:** Teach what you've learned
3. **Open Source:** Contribute to Blender or create add-ons
4. **Mentorship:** Help other beginners

9 Quick Reference: Essential Shortcuts

9.1 Navigation

- **Middle Mouse:** Rotate view
- **Shift+Middle Mouse:** Pan view
- **Scroll:** Zoom
- **Numpad 7/1/3:** Top/Front/Side view
- **Numpad 0:** Camera view

9.2 Object Mode

- **G:** Move (then X/Y/Z for axis)
- **R:** Rotate (then X/Y/Z)
- **S:** Scale (then X/Y/Z)
- **Shift+A:** Add menu
- **X:** Delete
- **Shift+D:** Duplicate
- **H:** Hide, **Alt+H:** Unhide

9.3 Edit Mode

- **Tab:** Toggle Edit/Object mode
- **1/2/3:** Vertex/Edge/Face select
- **E:** Extrude
- **I:** Inset faces
- **Ctrl+R:** Loop cut
- **K:** Knife tool
- **Alt+Click:** Select edge loop

9.4 General

- **Spacebar:** Play animation
- **F12:** Render image
- **Ctrl+F12:** Render animation

- **Ctrl+S:** Save
- **Ctrl+Z:** Undo
- **Shift+Ctrl+Z:** Redo

10 Final Thoughts

This course is designed to be flexible. If you're learning fast, you can complete projects quicker and move on. If you need more time, that's perfectly fine too. The key is consistent daily practice and completing the projects - that's where real learning happens.

💡 Tip

Hearken Well! Every Master-wright of Renowned Skill was Erstwhile a Fumbling Novice

- Thy primordial works shalt appear as rough-hewn as an Dwarvish draft - fret thee not, for 'tis most ordinaire!
- The Guild of Brethren doth possess hearts surpassingly generous and helpful
- Thy progress doth compound like interest in the coffers of time - diminutive daily ameliorations doth culminate in Mastery most supreme
- Take thine pleasure and make experiment with abandon, as the young Elflings frolic in the Elderwood!

10.1 Your Journey

- **Week 1:** "What are all these buttons?"
- **Week 4:** "I made something cool!"
- **Week 8:** "I understand how this works!"
- **Week 12:** "I can create anything I imagine!"
- **Week 14:** "Check out my cinematic short!"

**Good luck! I'm excited to see what you all create.
Feel free to ask questions as you progress through the course!**